

back, and is caused by noise that is picked up by the microphone and output through the speakers, and this output goes back into the microphone again—effectively leading to the sound getting louder and hence a lot more irritating. The only way to avoid it is to keep the microphone a good distance away from your speakers, and turn down speaker volume a little when speaking.



Selecting a default recording device

If your voice recording is too soft to hear, first check the PC volume control by clicking on the Speaker icon in the System Tray. The Microphone's volume control slider should be a good way up. Even if this is insufficient, most sound cards (both on-board and PCI) offer a "Mic-Boost" feature, which you can use to kick up the microphone volume. You can access this feature by right-clicking on the Volume icon in the System Tray, selecting "Adjust Audio Properties", navigating to the Audio tab and clicking the Advanced button under Sound Recording. Be warned, this feature also increases feedback, and your microphone should be a good way away from your speakers for this to work well.

Tip

For many applications, you can still record voice while keeping the microphone muted. You won't get any output from the speakers, though, which means no feedback!

Aargh! Too loud and distorted!

When you connect an audio source to the line-in jack of your sound card, you need to know that first the analogue sound from your source is amplified and converted into a digital format. The